



AI Automation Guide

Practical, ethical AI for a modern Canadian law firm

A comprehensive playbook of what AA Legal can automate, the tools that fit each task, step-by-step implementation guides, and visual explanations of how the pieces work together — all designed to free lawyers from administrative friction and let them focus on judgement, advocacy, and clients.

DOCUMENT

AI Automation Playbook

AUDIENCE

Partners · Staff · IT

JURISDICTION

Alberta, Canada

EDITION

2026 · v1.0

SECTION 01 — THE CASE FOR AI

Why AI Now, And Why It Matters For AA Legal

Roughly 40–60% of a typical lawyer’s day is spent on tasks that don’t require legal judgement — drafting boilerplate, summarising documents, hunting through emails, chasing payments, and re-typing intake data. AI can quietly eliminate most of that friction while keeping a human firmly in charge of every decision that matters.



Reclaim Billable Hours

TIME → VALUE

Automate intake, drafting first cuts, and document review so lawyers can spend more time on strategy, advocacy, and client relationships.



Lower Cost-To-Serve

MARGIN → UP

Flat-fee files (wills, real-estate, simple immigration) become dramatically more profitable when AI handles 50–70% of the production work.



Better Client Experience

SPEED + CLARITY

24/7 intake, instant document explanations in plain English, faster turnaround, and proactive status updates without staff overhead.



Reduce Risk & Errors

QUALITY → UP

AI-assisted deadline tracking, conflict checks, and second-eye review reduce the chance of missed limitations, fees, or clauses.

SECTION 02 — AUTOMATION CATALOGUE

14 High-Value Use Cases for AA Legal

Each card below describes a discrete automation: what it does, the recommended technology, the steps to implement, and the business impact. Use these as building blocks — most firms start with 2–3 and grow from there.



1 · 24/7 AI Intake Assistant

RECEPTION · AFTER-HOURS

What it does: A chatbot on aalegal.ca greets visitors, asks structured questions, captures matter type, urgency, and contact info, and books a consult slot — even at 2 AM.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Use an LLM-based chatbot (e.g., Smith.ai, LawDroid, or a custom GPT)

- Train it with practice-area FAQs and intake forms
- Integrate with Clio Grow / Calendly for booking
- Push leads into the CRM with conflict-check pre-screen

GUARDRAILS

- Always discloses it is an AI assistant
- Never gives legal advice — only collects information
- Escalates urgent matters to a human

Impact: High

Effort: Low



2 · AI-Assisted Drafting

WILLS · CONTRACTS · LETTERS

What it does: Generates first drafts of routine documents — wills, separation agreements, residential purchase contracts, demand letters — from a structured intake form.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Build precedent templates in Word / Google Docs
- Use a tool like Gavel, LawYaw, or HotDocs to map intake fields to clauses
- Add an AI layer (Harvey, Spellbook, or Microsoft Copilot for Word) for clause refinement and plain-English summaries
- Lawyer reviews & signs off before client delivery

Impact: High

Effort: Medium



3 · Contract & Document Review

REAL ESTATE · COMMERCIAL

What it does: Scans inbound contracts (purchase agreements, leases, condo docs, separation drafts) and flags missing clauses, unusual terms, deadlines, and risks.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Use Spellbook, Kira, or Harvey for clause extraction
- Configure a checklist per matter type (e.g., condo doc review checklist)
- AI produces a red-flag report; lawyer reviews

Impact: High

Effort: Medium



4 · AI Legal Research

CASE LAW · STATUTES

What it does: Answers legal questions with citations to Canadian case law and statutes, drafts memos, and surfaces analogous decisions.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Subscribe to Westlaw Edge Canada AI, Lexis+ AI, or CanLII
- Use Harvey or Vincent AI for memo drafting
- Always verify citations — never rely on raw LLM output

Impact: High

Effort: Low



5 · Email Triage & Drafting

INBOX HYGIENE

What it does: Sorts incoming email by urgency & matter, summarises long threads, and drafts reply suggestions in the lawyer's voice.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Microsoft Copilot for Outlook or Google Gemini in Gmail
- Custom rules to auto-tag by client & matter
- Daily AI-summarised inbox briefing at 7 AM

Impact: Medium

Effort: Low



6 · Passive Time Capture & Billing Narratives

REVENUE LEAKAGE

What it does: Detects time spent in documents, emails, and calls; generates compliant billing narratives; flags non-billable items.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Clio Duo, Smokeball AutoTime, or TimeSolv AI
- Train the model on AA Legal's preferred narrative style
- Lawyer approves the daily timesheet in one click

Impact: High

Effort: Low



7 · Conflict Check & KYC Automation

COMPLIANCE

What it does: Runs fuzzy-match conflict checks across past matters, automates LSA-compliant ID verification, and screens for PEPs / sanctions lists.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Persona, Onfido, or Trulioo for ID verification
- Clio Manage or LawConnect for conflict search with AI fuzzy match
- Automated FINTRAC screening API

Impact: High

Effort: Medium



8 · Deadline & Court-Rules Engine

RISK CONTROL

What it does: Calculates limitation periods, court filing deadlines, and IRCC processing timelines automatically from the matter type and key dates.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- LawToolBox, CalendarRules, or Clio's court-rules add-on
- AI parses orders / pleadings and auto-creates calendar entries
- SMS & email reminders 30 / 14 / 3 / 1 day(s) ahead

Impact: High

Effort: Medium



9 · Proactive Client Updates

CX · RETENTION

What it does: Sends automatic milestone updates ("Your offer was accepted", "Your PR application reached IRCC stage 2"), in plain English.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Workflow automation in Clio + Zapier / Make
- AI-generated messages from matter status changes
- Client portal notifications + email + SMS

Impact: Medium

Effort: Low



10 · Real-Estate Closing Workflow

HIGH VOLUME

What it does: End-to-end automation: order title search → review condo docs → draft statement of adjustments → generate closing package → e-sign → register at Land Titles.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Conveyancing software (Unity, ProSuite, or ConveyMore)
- AI condo-document summariser
- E-sign + remote commissioning via Notarius / Syngrafii

Impact: High

Effort: High



11 · Immigration Form & Eligibility AI

EXPRESS ENTRY · PNP

What it does: Calculates CRS scores, identifies the best program, pre-fills IRCC forms from client documents, and flags missing items.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Tracker Corp, Tracktion, or INSZoom (Mitratesh) immigration platforms
- OCR + AI to extract data from passports, transcripts, work letters
- Internal QA checklist before submission

Impact: High

Effort: Medium



12 · Wills, POAs & Estate Probate

DOCUMENT PRODUCTION

What it does: Generates wills, enduring POAs, and personal directives from an online questionnaire; produces probate applications from death certificate & asset inventory.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Gavel / LawYaw forms mapped to AA Legal precedents
- AI to summarise the will in plain English for the client
- Probate calculator + court form auto-fill

Impact: High

Effort: Medium



13 · Family & Criminal Litigation Prep

DISCOVERY · DISCLOSURE

What it does: Indexes large disclosure sets, summarises witness statements & police reports, builds chronologies, prepares cross-examination outlines.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- Everlaw, Relativity, or Reveal for e-discovery
- Harvey or Vincent for case summaries
- Internal AI bot trained on the matter folder (with strict access control)

Impact: Medium-High

Effort: High



14 · Marketing & Content Engine

GROWTH

What it does: Generates blog posts, social posts, monthly newsletter, and SEO-optimised practice-area pages from outlines provided by the lawyer.

HOW TO AUTOMATE

- ChatGPT Team / Claude for drafts; lawyer edits
- Canva Magic Studio for visuals
- Mailchimp + AI subject lines & scheduling

Impact: Medium

Effort: Low

SECTION 03 — VIRTUAL WALK-THROUGH

How the AI Stack Fits Together — A Visual Guide

Imagine AA Legal's technology like a six-storey building. Each floor has a job. Clients enter at the top, work flows down through automation layers, and lawyers sit at the centre approving everything important.

① CLIENT LAYER

How clients reach the firm

Website, AI intake chatbot, client portal, secure document upload, e-signing, SMS/email notifications. **Goal:** Make AA Legal accessible 24/7 without overloading reception.

② INTAKE & TRIAGE

Turning enquiries into matters

AI captures structured intake → conflict check → KYC/AML screening → matter type triage → recommended fee model → consult booking. **Goal:** Zero-touch lead-to-consult pipeline.

③ PRACTICE AUTOMATION

Where the work happens

Document drafting, contract review, legal research, deadline calculation, immigration form prep, real-estate conveyancing, e-discovery. **Goal:** Cut routine production time by 50–70%.

④ LAWYER REVIEW & DECISION

Human-in-the-loop

Every AI output is reviewed and approved by Yemi or a delegated staff lawyer. AI never sends, files, or signs anything without explicit lawyer sign-off. **Goal:** Maintain professional responsibility.

⑤ COMPLIANCE & TRUST ACCOUNTING

Guardrails

Trust ledger, billing & collections, FINTRAC reports, LSA audit trail, encrypted file storage, retention & destruction policy. **Goal:** Pass any audit, any day.

⑥ INSIGHTS & GROWTH

Dashboards on revenue, matter profitability, KPIs, client satisfaction, marketing

Closing the loop

performance. AI-generated content engine and review-request automation feed growth.

Goal: Continuous improvement.

SECTION 04 — A DAY IN THE LIFE

How AI Changes a Typical Real-Estate File

Follow a single residential purchase from enquiry to closing — with AI quietly doing the heavy lifting in the background.

RESIDENTIAL PURCHASE FILE — AI-AUGMENTED WORKFLOW



Steps highlighted in teal are AI-augmented. Lawyer sign-off remains mandatory at steps 4, 7, and 9.

THE OUTCOME

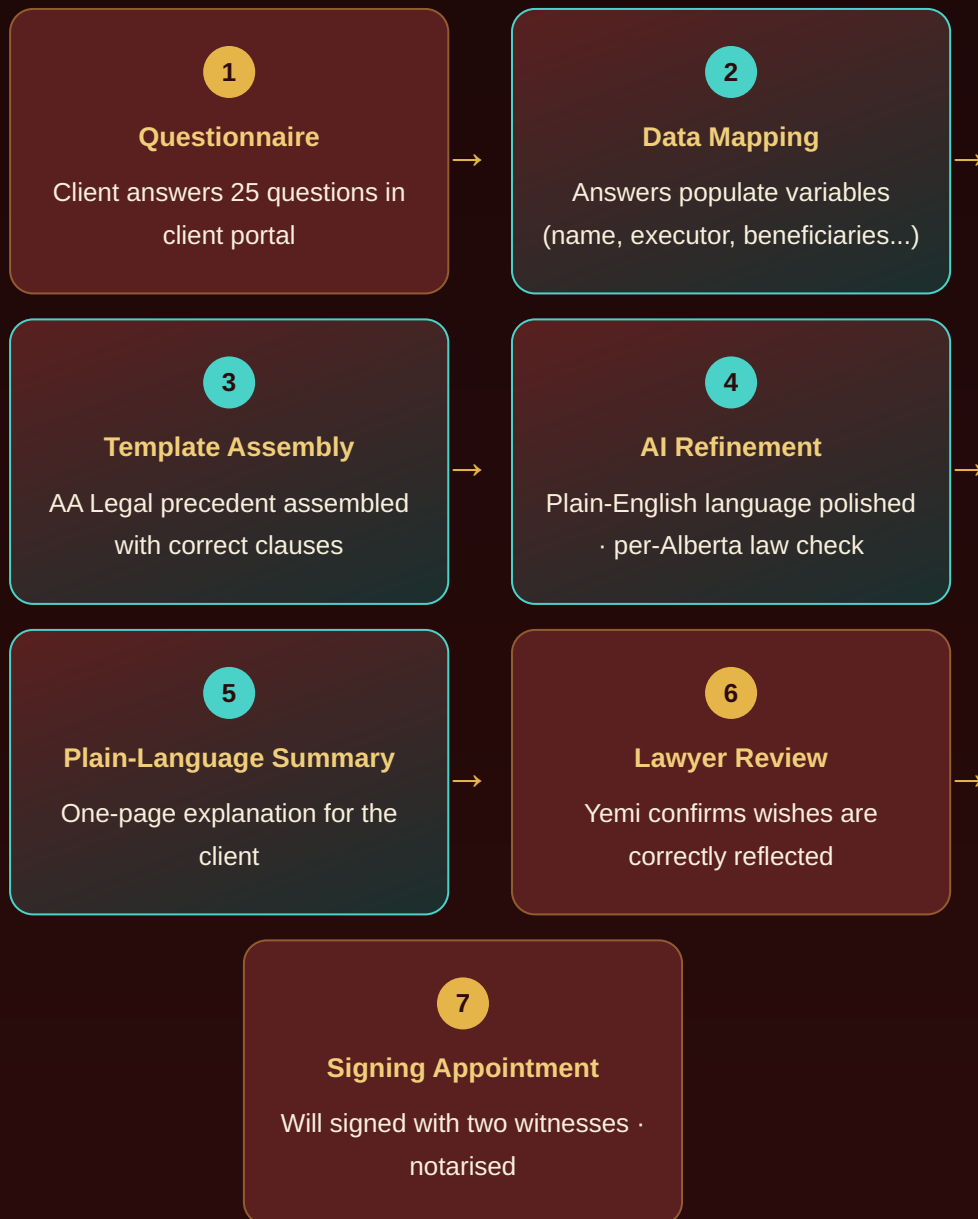
A file that traditionally consumed **6–8 hours of staff time** over 4 weeks is delivered in **2–3 hours of staff time** over the same period — with fewer errors, faster client communication, and a higher margin on a flat fee.

SECTION 05 — UNDER THE HOOD

How an AI Drafts a Will — Step by Step

Many people fear AI as a "black box". Here is exactly what happens when AA Legal uses AI to draft a will, in plain language.

FROM CLIENT QUESTIONNAIRE → FINISHED WILL



WHAT THE AI NEVER DECIDES

The AI does **not** choose beneficiaries, draft trust structures for tax planning, advise on capacity, or sign anything. It is a **production assistant** — the lawyer remains the brain of the operation.

SECTION 06 — IMPLEMENTATION

A 90-Day Rollout Plan for AA Legal

You do not need to do everything at once. Here is a phased plan that delivers quick wins in the first month and compounds into a fully AI-augmented practice within a year.

PHASE 0

Week 1 — Foundations

Get the House in Order

- Adopt a practice management system if not in place (Clio recommended)
- Move email to Microsoft 365 with Canadian tenancy
- Enable MFA across all staff accounts
- Sign LSA-compliant AI use policy

PHASE 1

Weeks 2–4 — Quick Wins

Low Risk, High Return

- Deploy AI intake chatbot on aalegal.ca
- Turn on AI email summaries & draft suggestions (Copilot)
- Switch to passive time capture (Clio Duo)
- Use ChatGPT Team / Claude for marketing content

PHASE 2

Weeks 5–8 — Document Production

Automate the Drafting

- Stand up Gavel/LawYaw for wills & POAs
- Adopt Spellbook for contract review
- Integrate Lexis+ AI or Westlaw Edge for research
- Train staff & build precedent library

PHASE 3

Weeks 9–12 — Practice-Specific

Tailored Workflows

- Real-estate conveyancing automation
- Immigration form & eligibility tools
- Deadline / court-rules engine
- Client-portal milestone notifications

PHASE 4

Months 4–6 — Optimisation

Measure & Improve

- KPI dashboards for matters & profitability
- Internal AI knowledge base (firm-trained)
- E-discovery for litigation files
- Quarterly AI ethics & security review

PHASE 5

Months 7–12 — Differentiation

Become the AI-Forward Firm

- Custom AI assistant trained on firm precedents
- Client-facing AI services (e.g., document explainers)
- Thought leadership: blog, webinars on AI & law
- Articling student supervised on AI workflows

SECTION 07 — TOOL RECOMMENDATIONS

Vetted Tools by Function

A starter shortlist, all of which have Canadian data-residency options or are widely used in Canadian firms. Verify vendor terms before signing.

FUNCTION	RECOMMENDED TOOLS	WHY
Practice Management	Clio Manage, CosmoLex, PCLaw	Trust accounting, matters, billing, court-rules
Intake Chatbot	Smith.ai, LawDroid, Intercom + custom GPT	Legal-aware, integrates with Clio
Drafting		

FUNCTION	RECOMMENDED TOOLS	WHY
	Gavel, LawYaw, HotDocs, Microsoft Copilot	Conditional templates + AI polishing
Contract Review	Spellbook, Kira, Harvey	Clause libraries & risk flagging
Legal Research	Lexis+ AI Canada, Westlaw Edge, vLex Vincent, CanLII	Citations to Canadian law you can trust
Time Capture	Clio Duo, Smokeball AutoTime, TimeSolv	Passive capture & AI narratives
KYC / AML	Persona, Onfido, Trulioo	FINTRAC / LSA-compliant ID verification
Court Rules	LawToolBox, CalendarRules	Auto-calendared deadlines
E-Sign / Notary	DocuSign, Adobe Sign, Notarius, Syngrafii	Canadian legal compliance
Conveyancing	Unity, ProSuite, ConveyMore	Alberta Land Titles integration
Immigration	Tracker Corp, Tracktion, INSZoom	IRCC forms & eligibility
E-Discovery	Everlaw, Relativity, Reveal	Disclosure indexing & review
General LLM	ChatGPT Team, Claude for Work, Microsoft Copilot	Drafting, summaries, analysis (no training on your data)

SECTION 08 — ETHICS & GUARDRAILS

Non-Negotiables When Using AI in a Canadian Law Firm

The Law Society of Alberta has issued guidance on generative AI. AA Legal's use of AI must respect every one of the following.

Competence

Lawyers must understand the AI tools they use, their limitations, and verify all outputs — especially citations.

Confidentiality

Only use AI tools that contractually prohibit training on client data and offer Canadian or SOC-2-compliant data hosting.

Privilege

Never paste privileged content into consumer LLMs. Use enterprise tiers with DPAs in place.

Supervision

Every AI output is reviewed by a qualified lawyer. AI does not sign, file, or advise.

Candour

Disclose AI use to clients where material, and in court where required.

Fees

Bill fairly: efficiency gains from AI should reduce client fees where charged by the hour.

Bias & Fairness

Be alert to AI-introduced bias, particularly in family, criminal, and immigration matters.

Records & Audit

Keep an audit log of significant AI uses on each file. Update retainer language to disclose AI tools.

AA LEGAL'S AI USE POLICY — ONE SENTENCE

"AI helps us work faster and clearer, but every legal judgement, every document delivered to a client, and every word filed with a court is owned, reviewed, and signed by a human lawyer at AA Legal."

SECTION 09 — INVESTMENT

Indicative Budget & ROI

Costs vary by vendor and seat count. These are realistic 2026 estimates for a small Canadian firm with 1 lawyer and 2 support staff.

CATEGORY	MONTHLY (CAD)	NOTES
Practice management (Clio Suite)	\$300–\$500	Per seat, includes Clio Duo AI add-on
AI drafting / contract review	\$200–\$600	Spellbook or Gavel
Legal research AI	\$200–\$400	Lexis+ AI Canada / Westlaw Edge
Intake chatbot	\$150–\$400	Smith.ai or similar
KYC / ID verification	\$2–\$5 per check	Variable, only when used
Microsoft 365 + Copilot	\$50–\$70 per seat	Canadian tenancy
E-sign / notarisation	\$50–\$150	DocuSign / Notarius
Total (typical)	~\$1,200–\$2,500 / month	Plus one-off setup ~\$3–5K

EXPECTED PAYBACK

If AI saves a single lawyer just **1 hour per day**, at a billed rate of \$350/hour over 220 working days, that is **~\$77,000 of recovered capacity per year** — a 25–50× return on a typical AI budget.

SECTION 10 — MEASURING SUCCESS

KPIs to Track Once AI Is Live



Time-To-First-Draft

SPEED

Target: 60% reduction across wills, real-estate, simple immigration matters.



Client NPS

EXPERIENCE

Target: ≥ 70 after 6 months. Survey at file close.



Matter Profitability

MARGIN

Target: +25% gross margin on flat-fee matters.



Error / Re-Work Rate

QUALITY

Target: $\leq 2\%$ files requiring substantive correction post-delivery.



Intake-to-Consult

FUNNEL

Target: 24-hour average; chatbot answers $\geq 70\%$ of FAQs.



Compliance Findings

RISK

Target: zero LSA audit findings; 100% conflict / KYC completion.

CLOSING

The Path Forward for AA Legal

AI is not a replacement for the wisdom, judgement, and compassion that define AA Legal — it is a force-multiplier for them. Start small, measure honestly, keep the lawyer in charge, and the firm will deliver

faster, more affordable, and more delightful legal services than ever before.

NEXT STEP

Choose **two** automations from Section 02 that map to AA Legal's busiest practice areas (suggested starters: *AI Intake Chatbot* and *Passive Time Capture*) and pilot them over a four-week sprint. Review results, refine, then layer in the next two.



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